

2019 to 2027, Monero's rate of supply inflation will be lower than Bitcoin's, but in all other periods the opposite is true.⁵⁸

Expectedly, Monero's ability to create privacy in transactions was a technological breakthrough that was recognized within the cryptoasset community and the markets. By the end of 2016, Monero had the fifth largest network value of any cryptocurrency and was the top performing digital currency in 2016, with a price increase over the year of 2,760 percent. This clearly demonstrates the level of interest in privacy protecting cryptocurrency. Some of that interest, no doubt, comes from less than savory sources.

Dash

Another cryptocurrency targeting privacy and fungibility is Dash. It launched its blockchain a few months before Monero, on January 19, 2014. Its lead developer, Evan Duffield, created Dash by forking the Bitcoin protocol and implementing a coin focused on privacy and speedy settlement of transactions. The Dash white paper that Duffield coauthored outlined his intent:

A crypto-currency based on Bitcoin, the work of Satoshi Nakamoto, with various improvements such as a two-tier incentivized network, known as the Masternode network. Included are other improvements such as Darksend, for increasing fungibility and InstantX which allows instant transaction confirmation without a centralized authority.⁵⁹

Dash, however, got off to a rocky start. Instead of a premine, it had what is called an *instamine*, where 1.9 million coins were created in the first 24 hours. Considering that three years later, in January 2017, there were just north of 7 million coins, this